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Emergency declared over Ebola outbreak

WHO calls for response after 300 suspected cases, 88 fatalities seen

By Chinedu Asadu and Saleh Mwanamilongo
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ABUJA, Nigeria — The World Health Organization declared the Ebola disease outbreak caused by a rare virus in Congo and neighboring Uganda a public health emergency of international concern on Sunday, after more than 300 suspected cases and 88 deaths.

WHO said the outbreak doesn't meet the criteria of a pandemic emergency like COVID-19 and advised against the closure of international borders.

The emergency declaration is meant to spur donor agencies and member countries into action. By WHO's standards, it shows the event is serious, there is a risk of international spread, and it requires a coordinated international response.

The U.S. Agency for International Development has played a major role in containing previous outbreaks, but last year it was shuttered by the Trump administration. The administration also cut funding for the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, the top public health agency in the country. It also withdrew in January from the WHO.

The organization said on X that a laboratory-confirmed case has also been reported in Congo's capital, Kinshasa, about 620 miles from the outbreak's epicenter in the eastern province of Ituri, suggesting a possible wider spread. It said the patient had visited Ituri and that other suspected cases have also been reported in North Kivu province, one of Congo's most populous and borders Ituri.

On Sunday, the rebel government of Goma, eastern Congo's largest city, said in a statement that the first confirmed case of Ebola was detected in the city. The infected person traveled from Ituri province and was currently under isolation, the statement said. Goma was the site of a rebel offensive in early 2025, and the conflict between the Congolese armed forces and the Rwanda-backed M23 rebel paramilitary group has displaced hundreds of thousands.

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Workers monitor the control room in April at the Braidwood Generating Station nuclear power plant, owned by Constellation Energy. State legislation has played a key role in preserving nuclear generation. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS**

New life for nuclear

As data centers seek more power, giant energy producer Constellation launches nuclear plant upgrades in Illinois to meet the rising demand

By Christiana Freitag
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

BRACEVILLE, Ill. — Inside Illinois' largest nuclear power plant, massive turbines pull 100,000 gallons of water a minute from Braidwood Lake.

On a recent tour of the Braidwood Nuclear Generating Station, a sprawling facility the size of two football fields and anchored by dual reactors, Constellation operators and technicians worked around the clock. Every 18 months, the plant shuts down one of its nuclear reactors and brings in over a thousand specialized contractors to replace fuel and perform maintenance.

This latest refueling sets the stage as the plant prepares for its biggest upgrade yet, said Dwayne Pickett, Constellation vice president of government affairs and regulatory advocacy.

"There's a need for power," he said. "There's an opportunity

to add power and to meet that need."

Rising electricity demand from data centers has broadened the state's outlook on renewables as well as given new life to nuclear.

"We've had the growth of renewable power and wind and solar power," Pickett said. "So the opportunity for nuclear just hasn't been there. But with this growth in the data economy, there's an opportunity for Illinois to transition from this period where nuclear plants are barely surviving to a point where we can actually invest in the plants."

Constellation, the largest clean energy producer in the U.S., has spent \$800 million to increase output at its two largest nuclear plants in Illinois: Braidwood in Will County and Byron, southwest of Rockford.

These upgrades, known as "uprates," will add a combined

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Workers replace a transformer near a cooling tower last month at Constellation's Braidwood Generating Station nuclear power plant.

"People don't like using the word nuclear renaissance. But it's what this moment is."

— **DWAYNE PICKET**, Constellation vice president of government affairs and regulatory advocacy

DraftKings to end retail sportsbook at Wrigley

Venue will stay open, but in-person betting there stops May 31

By Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Blaming increased Illinois wagering taxes, DraftKings is shutting down its two-year-old retail sportsbook at Wrigley Field, a high-profile but small part of its business.

DraftKings, one of the leading sportsbooks in the state, will continue to operate online across Illinois, but the last day to place your bets in-person at the Friendly Confines will be May 31.



DraftKings will remain open as a sports bar at Wrigley Field, the company said. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

"DraftKings has made the decision to discontinue onsite sportsbook operations at DraftKings Sportsbook at Wrigley Field following a review of our retail presence in Illinois," the company said in a statement. "The venue itself will remain open, but in-person sports betting will no longer be offered at the location."

Launched in March 2024, DraftKings at Wrigley Field is the only operating retail sportsbook in Illinois connected to a sports venue. FanDuel, which is associated with Fairmont Park near St. Louis, and DraftKings, which remains partnered with the Casino Queen in

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ICE detains Chicago high school senior and mother during check-in

Asylum petition still pending as both held in jails since March

By Gregory Royal Pratt
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

By this time in May, Ricardo Hernandez-Navarrete expected to be preparing for his high school prom and training to play soccer in the fall at a local community college.

But the 18-year-old Chicago Public Schools student's plans are in jeopardy after he and his mother, Liliana, were arrested in mid-March by Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents at a routine check-in for the family's asylum case.

Originally from Colombia,

Ricardo and his mother came to the United States in 2022, when he was 15 years old. She filed for asylum and that petition remains pending, court records show.

Each of them was taken to Kentucky jails for detention, but the government separated them and is holding them in different facilities. For two months, the mother and son have had almost zero face-to-face contact, Ricardo told the Tribune in an interview from jail.

"I miss my mother," he said. "I miss playing soccer."

Attorneys for the mother and son have filed habeas corpus petitions in federal court seeking to have them released on bond while their immigration

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Drone hits UAE nuclear plant

A drone strike sparked a fire on the edge of the United Arab Emirates' nuclear power plant in what authorities called a terrorist attack. **Nation & World, B1**

Mars delivers feel-good show

Bruno Mars brought his "Romantic Tour" to Chicago over the weekend, a 120-minute revue-style concert that evoked prior eras. **Arts & Living, B5**

Sox win City Series finale

The deciding game of the White Sox-Cubs series ended with a dramatic home run by Sox catcher Edgar Quero that put his team ahead 9-8. **Sports, C1**

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